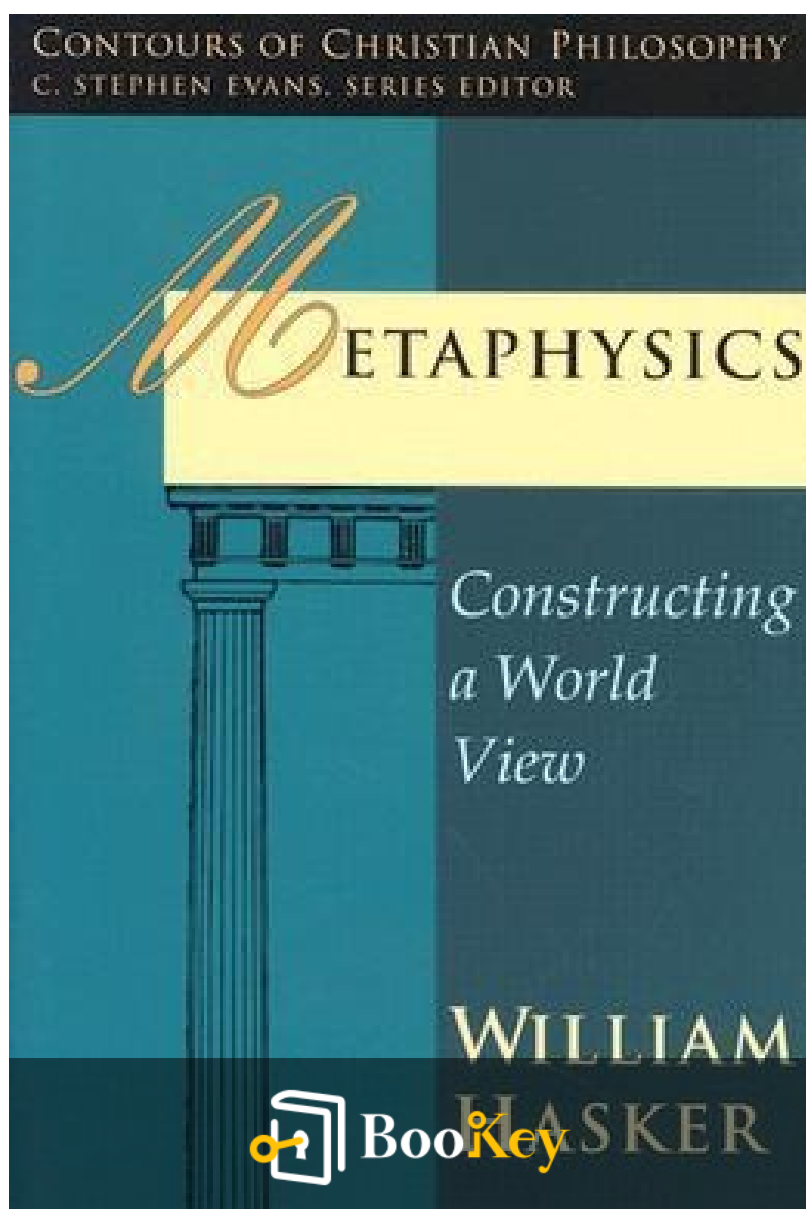


# Metaphysics PDF

William Hasker



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# Metaphysics

Exploring Reality, God, and Human Existence  
Through Metaphysical Inquiry.

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## About the book

In "Metaphysics," William Hasker delves into the fundamental questions of existence, exploring the nature of reality, the characteristics of God, and the essence of human consciousness. He investigates whether humans possess minds and souls beyond mere physical brains, and whether our actions are the result of free will or predetermined circumstances. Through thoughtful analysis and rigorous evaluation, Hasker guides readers toward developing a coherent worldview that illuminates the complexities of the universe and the human experience.

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## About the author

William Hasker is a prominent American philosopher renowned for his contributions to the philosophy of religion, metaphysics, and philosophy of mind. Born in 1936, he has engaged deeply with topics such as the nature of free will, the problem of evil, and the existence of God, drawing from both classical and contemporary philosophical traditions. Hasker is also recognized for his development of the concept of "open theism," which emphasizes a dynamic relationship between God and creation, challenging traditional views of divine foreknowledge. His scholarly work, characterized by rigorous analysis and clarity, has made significant impacts on both academic discourse and discussions within the broader Christian community. In addition to his influential writings, Hasker has served as a professor at several institutions, contributing to the education of future generations of philosophers.

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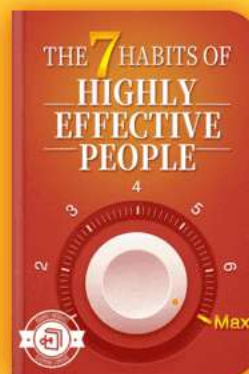
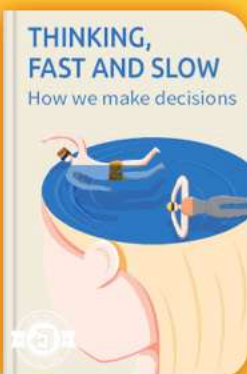


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# Chapter 1 Summary : Part One: Open Theism and the Greatness of God



| Section                                | Summary                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introduction                           | Hasker discusses the need for a more expansive understanding of God, as contemporary beliefs may still fall short in recognizing God's true vastness.                       |
| The Greatness of God                   | Emphasizes understanding God's immensity and how human constructs can narrow our view of the divine, challenging faith to align with modern scientific perspectives.        |
| Open Theism                            | Introduces the idea that God allows genuine independence among creatures, fostering authentic relationships, contrasting with theological determinism.                      |
| Analogy of Human Qualities             | Proposes recognizing qualities seen in admirable humans—strength, wisdom, compassion—to enhance the perception of the divine.                                               |
| Evolutionary Understanding             | Aligns open theism with an evolutionary perspective, suggesting God desires autonomy and growth in creation, portraying a dynamic universe.                                 |
| Emergentism and the Nature of the Soul | Advocates for an emergent view of the soul that sees consciousness as a result of complex bodily interactions, supporting the evolution of personhood.                      |
| Conclusion                             | Presents a unified view of open theism, evolutionary understanding, and emergentism, offering a compassionate, powerful God engaged with creation, meeting spiritual needs. |

## The Need for a Bigger God

William Hasker

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## Introduction

In his book *\*Your God Is Too Small\**, J. B. Phillips critiques simplistic notions of God, urging a more expansive understanding. Hasker suggests that contemporary beliefs still require a “bigger God” to match the vastness of the universe and the complexities of modern thought.

## The Greatness of God

Hasker emphasizes the need for a comprehension of God's true immensity, reflecting on how human constructs can limit our conception of the divine. He argues that modern science reveals a universe too vast for a localized deity and challenges us to reconcile our faith with this reality.

## Open Theism

Hasker introduces “open theism,” the idea that God allows genuine independence among His creatures, which entails risks but also fosters authentic relationships. This contrasts sharply with theological determinism, where God predetermines all actions, removing free will. According to

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Hasker, the open theistic view fosters a more personal and relational God.

## **Analogy of Human Qualities**

Hasker proposes that understanding God as a "big person" involves recognizing qualities seen in admirable humans—strength, wisdom, compassion—all of which can serve to enhance our perception of the divine.

## **Evolutionary Understanding**

The author aligns open theism with an evolutionary perspective, suggesting that God desires His creation to be “Other,” capable of autonomy and growth. He argues that viewing the universe as evolutionary complements the belief that God’s creation is dynamic and ongoing.

## **Emergentism and the Nature of the Soul**

Hasker discusses the nature of the soul, advocating an emergent view that sees consciousness as a product of complex interactions within the body rather than a separate, immaterial essence. This perspective supports the idea of

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personhood developing through evolutionary processes.

## Conclusion

In sum, Hasker presents a unified view consisting of open theism, an evolutionary understanding of the universe, and an emergentist perspective on the soul. He believes this framework presents a God that is not only immense and powerful but also compassionate and deeply engaged with His creation. By reconciling these views, believers may find a conception of God that meets their spiritual needs.

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## Example

**Key Point:** The need for an expansive understanding of God illustrates the interplay between divinity and human autonomy.

**Example:** Imagine standing beneath a starry sky, each twinkling light symbolizing the vast possibilities in your life, where you have the freedom to choose your path. Just like those stars that stretch infinitely above, consider how a greater conception of God can embrace your need for autonomy while also being deeply engaged in your journey, allowing you to grow and flourish in your choices. Instead of seeing God as a distant puppeteer, envision Him as a loving guide, encouraging your growth and empowering your decisions amidst the vast universe.

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## Critical Thinking

**Key Point:** The Concept of God in Modern Thought

**Critical Interpretation:** Hasker's argument for a more expansive conception of God challenges traditional views, yet his interpretation of divine openness and evolution may not encompass all theological perspectives. Readers could explore critiques of open theism in works such as 'God of the Possible' by Greg Boyd or 'Divine Foreknowledge' by William Lane Craig, which raise questions about the compatibility of free will and divine omniscience.

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# Chapter 2 Summary : The Need for a Bigger God



## The Need for a Bigger God

### Introduction

William Hasker discusses the need for a more expansive and adequate conception of God, referencing J.B. Phillips' book "Your God Is Too Small." Hasker argues against limited perceptions of God that resemble outdated or inadequate caricatures.

### The Immensity of God

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Hasker emphasizes that God is immense and greater than traditional anthropomorphic views. Modern scientific discoveries, demonstrating the vastness of the universe, challenge simplistic notions of a localized or small deity. He asserts that the universe's enormity should lead to a belief in an at once infinite yet personal God.

## **Concept of Bigness in God**

Exploring “bigness,” Hasker equates it to personal qualities rather than physical size. Attributes such as strength, wisdom, reliability, and understanding characterize what it means to be a 'big person' or a great leader, qualities that can inform our understanding of God’s character.

## **Open Theism**

Open theism posits that God allows individuals to possess real independence and decision-making ability. This view sees God as a big person who takes risks in allowing genuine freedom, rather than a deterministic deity who micromanages every detail of existence.

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## **Theological Determinism vs. Open Theism**

Hasker contrasts open theism with theological determinism, where God preordains every action. He argues that a too-controlling God would be inadequate and too small, and instead champions a conception of God who grants autonomy while remaining involved.

## **Implications on Creation and Evolution**

The open theistic view supports a dynamic understanding of creation, affirming an evolutionary framework where creation is genuinely capable of becoming 'Other.' This underscores human independence and the capacity for evolution within the divine order.

## **Nature of the Soul**

Hasker discusses two views on the nature of the soul: traditional immaterial substance vs. emergentism, positing that the soul emerges from biological processes. This aligns with an evolutionary understanding of creation where personhood reflects the creative capacities inherent in nature.

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## Interrelation of Science and Theology

The interplay between shaping principles in science and theology reveals the necessity of open theism in engaging with contemporary scientific discourse. Hasker highlights that open theists should involve themselves in scientific discussions, not out of conflict but rather to seek a consistent harmony between faith and reason.

### Conclusion: Proposing a Big Enough God

Finally, Hasker proposes that a conception of God, amalgamating openness, emergentist views, and an acceptance of an evolutionary cosmos, can provide a robust and fulfilling understanding of divinity, one that is relevant to modern spiritual needs and challenges.

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# Chapter 3 Summary : Part Two: Science and Open Theism

## Science and Open Theism: Methodological Insights

### Introduction

Philosophers of science have typically had minimal influence in academia compared to figures like Thomas Kuhn, whose work highlighted that science relies on various unarticulated assumptions known as metatheoretic shaping principles (MSPs). This chapter examines the relationship between science and theology, specifically in the context of open theism.

### The Structure of Science

Science comprises three layers: the empirical layer (observations and data), the theoretical layer (laws and models), and the MSP layer (which bridges philosophy and science). The MSPs can be categorized into two

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types—metaphysical and epistemic.

## **Metaphysical MSPs**

These include:

-

### **Uniformity of Nature**

: Laws of nature remain constant across time and space.

-

### **Realism**

: Scientific theories reflect truths about reality, rather than merely being social constructs.

-

### **Causal Closure**

: Every physical event has a sufficient physical cause, aligning closely with metaphysical naturalism.

## **Epistemic MSPs**

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# Chapter 4 Summary : Metatheoretic Shaping Principles

## Metatheoretic Shaping Principles Where Science Meets Theology

### Introduction

Philosophers of science have historically been less influential in academia, with Thomas Kuhn's "The Structure of Scientific Revolutions" being a notable exception. It helped uncover the unspoken assumptions in scientific practice, prompting a reflection on metatheoretic shaping principles (MSPs) that influence both science and theology. This chapter examines different categories of MSPs, their evolution, and their implications for themes like open theism.

### The Structure of Science

Science can be conceptually divided into three layers:

- 1.

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## **Observations and Data**

: The foundational layer built upon empirical findings.

2.

## **Theories and Laws**

: This abstract layer consists of laws of nature and established theories, which offer explanations based on data but are not directly connected to first principles.

3.

## **Metatheoretic Shaping Principles**

: These principles define what constitutes a good theory or law and how they are developed, merging philosophy with scientific inquiry.

## **Categories of MSPs**

-

### **Metaphysical MSPs**

: Include principles like:

-

### **Uniformity of Nature**

: Laws are consistent across space and time.

-

### **Realism**

: Theories depict truths about reality rather than mere

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constructions.

-

### **Causal Closure**

: All physical events must have sufficient physical causes, resonating with metaphysical naturalism.

-

### **Epistemic MSPs**

: Encompass methodological guidelines such as:

-

### **Reliance on Repeatable Observations**

: A core distinction between modern and earlier scientific practices.

-

### **Explanatory Virtues**

: Criteria for good explanations, including simplicity and coherence.

-

### **Methodological Naturalism (MN)**

: The tendency to analyze phenomena only through naturalistic principles.

### **MSPs and Theism**

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MSPs often present tensions with theism, especially regarding realism, reductionism, and MN:

-

### **Reductionism**

can conflict with theistic beliefs since theism includes entities beyond material existence.

-

### **Methodological Naturalism**

raises concerns as it often implies a naturalistic interpretation of phenomena, which can challenge theistic explanations.

## **Open Theism and its Tensions with MSPs**

While open theism primarily rejects deterministic causation and leans toward anti-realism regarding fixed future events, its influences are limited:

1. Open theists view the future as open, while traditional models see it as determined.
2. Tension arises in theories that imply determinism, as well as those suggesting an unchangeable future.

## **Conclusion**

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The chapter argues that theology and science can influence MSPs while emphasizing the importance of allowing for ongoing dialogue. Open theism does not impose strict boundaries against scientific discoveries and should be prepared for potential conflicts between scientific understanding and divine action. The relationship between faith and reason need not be an adversarial one, allowing for an enriching discourse that blends both domains.

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# Chapter 5 Summary : Religious Belief Formation

## Religious Belief Formation: A Kantian Perspective Informed by Science

\*David Basinger\*

### Introduction

The formation of religious belief is influenced by various external factors. This chapter outlines initial assumptions regarding religious belief formation, treats these assumptions as a Kantian hypothesis, and explores their implications.

### Initial Assumptions

-

### Libertarian Freedom

: Individuals possess libertarian freedom and can choose their religious beliefs amidst influencing factors.

-

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## **Influential Factors**

: Several factors influence belief formation:

1.

### **Genetic Factors**

: Genetics contribute to traits affecting religious belief openness and formation.

2.

### **Cultural Conditioning**

: Subconscious cultural influences significantly shape basic religious beliefs.

3.

### **Explicit Teaching**

: Religious beliefs are greatly impacted by teachings from significant figures in one's life.

4.

### **Brain Function**

: Cognitive processes of the brain affect how beliefs are formed and retained, often filtering information based on pre-existing beliefs.

## **Kantian Hypothesis**

- There is an external reality that we understand through factors beyond our control. Thus, while some beliefs may be

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justified, proving their superiority over other perspectives objectively is not feasible.

## **Key Points of the Hypothesis**

1. We cannot reliably ascertain whether our belief-forming faculties function properly or provide true beliefs.
2. Our belief options are influenced by genetics, culture, early teachings, and cognitive processing.
3. Awareness of these influences can lead to belief modification but cannot objectively validate a specific perspective over others.

## **Confirming Examples**

- Historical shifts in belief within religions highlight that past believers may have affirmed ideas now widely rejected. Examples include changing attitudes toward slavery and interpretations of scriptural events.

## **Practical Implications**

-

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: Instructors should present religious issues with epistemic humility, acknowledging that differing perspectives can be justified.

-

### **Religious Tolerance**

: Encouraging belief assessment may enhance understanding and minimize intolerance by fostering respect between differing belief systems.

-

### **Epistemic Humility**

: Acknowledging that our beliefs today might not hold the same weight in the future encourages continuous reflection.

### **Conclusion**

Engagement in serious belief assessment remains vital, as it can clarify beliefs and allow for their modification.

Understanding that beliefs are shaped by various factors should guide respectful dialogue and reflection within the religious landscape. Despite the limitations of our perspectives, the potential for personal and communal growth through reflection is significant.

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# Chapter 6 Summary : Part Three: Open Theism, Time, and Relativity

| Section                            | Summary                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introduction to Open Theism        | Open theism emphasizes that the future is not predetermined and that God has a dynamic relationship with creation, necessitating a mutable understanding of divine knowledge.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Five Senses of Openness Defined    | <p>Causal Openness: Multiple causally possible futures exist, rejecting determinism.</p> <p>Ontic Openness: No uniquely determined series of world states arises from the present; includes presentism and growing block theory.</p> <p>Alethic Openness: No complete true narrative of the future exists; may deny bivalence or affirm future contingents as false.</p> <p>Epistemic Openness: Certain aspects of the future are unknowable, raising theological debates regarding divine omniscience.</p> <p>Providential Openness: God has not ordained all that will happen, contrasting with meticulous providence.</p> |
| Interdependencies Among the Senses | Argues that if the future is causally open, it reflects all other forms of openness (alethic, epistemic, ontic, and providential).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Implications of Causal Openness    | <p>Causality and Truth: If future contingents exist, knowledge open epistemic situation for God.</p> <p>Theological Dependence: God's relational nature necessitates an open future, opposing strict determinism.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Conclusion                         | Affirming causal openness supports open theism and challenges non-open theist views, indicating a coherent stance within classical theism that relates a dynamically evolving future with divine knowledge.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

## The Fivefold Openness of the Future

## Introduction to Open Theism

Open theism is a branch of theism characterized by two main aspects: the openness of the future and the openness of God. The future is considered open as things unfold progressively through choices and events, rather than being fully predetermined. God's openness reflects His dynamic relationship with creation, necessitating a mutable understanding of His knowledge.

## **Five Senses of Openness Defined**

1.

### **Causal Openness**

: The future is causally open if multiple causally possible futures exist relative to the present moment. This indicates the presence of indeterminism and rejects deterministic views.

2.

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# Chapter 7 Summary : The Fivefold Openness of the Future

## Summary of Chapter 7: The Fivefold Openness of the Future by Alan R. Rhoda

### Introduction to Open Theism

Open theism is characterized by its dual focus on the openness of both the future and God. The future is seen as not predetermined, shaped by human choices, while God's knowledge evolves in relationship with creation. This interdependence highlights the necessity of an open future for a God who engages in dynamic relationships.

### Five Senses of Openness

The chapter identifies five senses in which the future may be considered "open":

1.

#### Causal Openness

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: The future includes multiple causally possible scenarios based on indeterminism.

2.

### **Ontic Openness**

: The world state at any given time does not determine a unique series of future states.

3.

### **Alethic Openness**

: There is no complete and true narrative of the future.

4.

### **Epistemic Openness**

: Knowledge of the future is not infallibly certain, especially for an omniscient God.

5.

### **Providential Openness**

: The future is not completely ordained by God but allows for free will.

## **Interdependencies Among Openness Senses**

Rhoda argues that these five senses are interconnected through various symmetry principles. For example, if the future is causally open, it must also be open in the other four senses. This suggests that open theism may represent the

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only viable model for free will within theistic frameworks.

## **Metaphysical Clarifications**

Rhoda discusses key terms such as "state of affairs," "proposition," "world state," and emphasizes the need for precision in understanding openness and truth in relation to time.

## **Philosophical Arguments for Open Theism**

The recognition that if the future is epistemically open, it must also be alethically, causally, ontically, and providentially open strengthens the case for open theism. Each aspect of openness affects the others, suggesting a cohesive framework.

## **Concluding Reflections on Open Theism**

Open theism provides a compelling perspective on divine knowledge and human freedom. A future characterized by possibilities and relational dynamics reinforces a dynamic understanding of God and existence, emphasizing that the shape of the future is actively influenced by human choices.

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## Final Remarks

Rhoda concludes that for those who accept causal openness, it inevitably leads to acceptance of the other forms of openness, positioning open theism as a legitimate theological position within broader discussions of free will and divine omniscience.

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# Chapter 8 Summary : Presentism and the Problem of Special Relativity

## Chapter 8 Summary: Presentism and the Problem of Special Relativity

### Introduction

Open Theism, characterized by its relational theology, posits that a dynamic relationship between God and creation is intrinsic to divine value. This view suggests that the future is not predetermined, which aligns with the belief that God is temporal and does not possess exhaustive foreknowledge. Critics often argue that this perspective is incompatible with established physics, notably the theory of Special Relativity (SR). The author contends that it is possible to harmonize Open Theism with the findings of physics without discarding its core tenets.

### Presentism: Basic Concepts

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Presentism asserts that only currently existing entities are real, contrasting with eternalism, which posits that past and future entities are equally real. Presentism focuses on the importance of the present moment, whereas eternalism treats all points in time with equal ontological significance.

## **Intuitive Appeal of Presentism**

Presentism resonates with our experiences of time, emphasizing the uniqueness of the present moment, the existence of substances in the now, and the directional nature of time, where we feel unable to revisit the past or predict the future adequately. Presentism fits well with the relational aspects of Open Theology, highlighting the dynamic nature of divine relationships.

## **Challenges to Presentism**

Despite its appeal, presentism faces issues from scientific theories. The significant critique arises from its relationship with SR, particularly in terms of temporality and simultaneity. The lack of an absolute notion of simultaneity complicates the presentist perspective, challenging the idea of an ontological present defined independently of observers’

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perspectives.

## Analyzing Special Relativity

In SR, simultaneity is not absolute but relative to observers' positions. Events that are simultaneous in one frame of reference may not be in another. This relativity undermines the presentist view, which desires a single, privileged present. Minkowski spacetime represents a four-dimensional structure, complicating the presentist's assertion of a unique present.

## Alternative Solutions to Presentism's Problems

The author discusses multiple potential responses to the critiques faced by presentism, including modifying the understanding of SR or offering new interpretations of temporal ontology. For instance, the notion of relationalism suggests considering spacetime's properties concerning entities rather than treating them as standalone.

## Relationalism and Open Theism

Relationalism posits that time is defined through relations

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among existing entities, allowing for a dynamic interplay where God interacts with creation. This view supports an understanding of time that aligns with Open Theism by suggesting that the present moment is a product of current relationships, thus enabling a flexible interpretation within the framework of SR.

## Concluding Thoughts

Presentism can coexist with SR if one accepts the relativity of simultaneity and emphasizes the importance of relationships in defining the present. The paper argues that the critiques of presentism based on SR fail to demonstrate an insurmountable conflict, as presentists can affirm the structure of the Minkowski manifold while maintaining their ontological commitments. The author encourages continued exploration of presentism and its implications for metaphysical and theological discussions.

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# Chapter 9 Summary : Open Theism and the Metaphysics of the Space-Time Manifold

## Open Theism and the Metaphysics of the Space-Time Manifold

### Introduction

The paper discusses the relationship between Open Theism and metaphysical debates on time, emphasizing that Open Theists should adopt A-theories of time, particularly presentism. The author addresses objections against presentism stemming from Special Relativity (SR) and explores the positions of notable critics and defenders of presentism.

### A-theory vs. B-theory

- A-theorists advocate an objective distinction between past, present, and future.

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- B-theorists deny such objectivity.
- Terms: A-properties (past, present, future) vs. B-relations (earlier, later, simultaneous).
- A-theorists take tense seriously and assert that the truth associated with time must not be frozen.

## **Presentism among A-theories**

- Presentism posits that only the present exists.
- Various A-theories are considered, including growing block theory and bull's-eye theory.
- Concerns are raised about whether presentism can account for truths relating to past events without affirming their existence.

## **Tensed and Tense-neutral Notions of Existence**

- Examines how presentists use language about existence in a

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# Chapter 10 Summary : Part Four: Open Theism and Religious Life

## Summary of Chapter 10: Prayer and Open Theism: A Participatory, Co-Creator Model

### Introduction

This chapter explores an open-theist perspective on the efficacy of petitionary prayer, proposing a "co-creator model" that aligns with Biblical teachings on faith and persistence in prayer, while asserting that prayer can effect real change.

### Rejection of Purely Psychological Models

The author dismisses models that reduce prayer's efficacy to mere psychological effects, emphasizing that scriptural portrayals suggest prayer impacts reality beyond mere self-transformation.

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## Naturalistic Models of Prayer

Naturalistic models are critiqued for excluding God's direct involvement, instead suggesting that prayer exerts a non-local influence akin to the placebo effect. Despite apparent strengths, this interpretation fails to engage God as a responsive actor in prayer.

## Co-Creator Model of Petitionary Prayer

The co-creator model asserts that both humans and God collaborate in fulfilling prayer requests. It posits that God has self-restrained to enable human agency and genuine relational dynamics. This model redefines efficacy in terms of prayers that make a tangible difference in reality.

## Three Classical Models of Prayer

1.

### Theological Determinism

: Suggests that God's predetermined decisions nullify any influence from human prayer.

2.

### Molinism

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: Proposes that human actions, especially prayer, can influence outcomes without affecting God's prior knowledge or decisions, but lacks a strong causal connection.

3.

### **Open Theism**

: Provides a model where prayer affects God, offering potential relational growth, yet is critiqued for potentially reducing divine agency to administrative decision-making.

## **Faith and Persistence in Prayer**

The chapter emphasizes the necessity of faith and persistence in prayer, aligning with scriptural teachings that affirm these as essential to effective petitionary prayer. It encourages a dynamic relationship between the individual and God, advocating for a vision of prayer that fosters mutual collaboration rather than mere request fulfillment.

## **Challenges of Unanswered Prayer**

Reasons for unanswered prayers are explored, including spiritual obstacles and the need for persistence. The chapter suggests that faith and active participation in prayer serve to foster deeper connections with God and others, rather than

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leading to a transactional or blame-oriented view of prayer.

## Conclusion

The co-creator model positions prayer as a significant partner in divine-action and human agency, emphasizing that prayer not only necessitates faith and persistence but is inherently relational, enriching both the individual's spiritual life and their relationship with God.

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# Chapter 11 Summary : Prayer and Open Theism

## Prayer and Open Theism: A Participatory, Co-Creator Model

### Introduction

This paper presents a non-process, open-theist account of petitionary prayer, termed the “co-creator model.” It assumes the efficacy of petitionary prayer while emphasizing the importance of faith and persistence, as depicted in Christian scriptures. The paper posits that prayer can bring about change beyond mere psychological influence and involves God's special action. It rejects the purely "consciousness-raising" model of prayer, advocating for the co-creator model that acknowledges God's direct involvement in responding to prayers.

### Three Classical Models of Prayer

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1.

### **Theological Determinist Model**

: In this view, God predestines all actions, meaning prayer does not influence God's decisions. While Jane's prayer precedes her healing, it is determined by God's will and not her request.

2.

### **Molinist Model**

: This perspective allows for the understanding that prayer can make a difference without causing God to change His mind. It suggests that if Peter had not prayed, the lame man would not have been healed, highlighting a conditional relationship without direct causal influence.

3.

### **Apex Model**

: Open theists support this model, which suggests that prayer affects God, who then decides how to respond. However, critics argue that this can reduce God to a mere executor of pre-existing moral criteria, losing relational depth.

### **The Co-Creator Model**

The co-creator model proposes that God and humans

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collaborate in the unfolding of events. Prayer is seen as a way through which humans and God can jointly create outcomes. This model emphasizes that effective prayer is not just about influencing God but involve a relationship where both parties engage. It also acknowledges that God's ability to act can be influenced by prayer, creating "openings" for divine action.

## **Faith, Grace, and Personal Effort**

The model outlines a redefined notion of faith, connecting it to envisioning unrealized possibilities and affirming potential in oneself and others. Instead of faith being self-generated, it is depicted as received from God, often referred to as the "faith of Christ." The interaction with God facilitates the required faith and persistence for effective prayer.

## **Unanswered Prayer**

The paper addresses the challenges of unanswered prayers, suggesting that they can stem from a lack of faith, persistence, or external spiritual obstacles. It argues that unanswered prayers do not indicate divine neglect but may be linked to the complex dynamics of faith, divine purpose, and human free will.

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## Conclusion

This model incorporates the key tenets of open theism, emphasizing the collaborative relationship between God and humans in prayer while maintaining the scriptural significance of faith and persistence. It proposes a nuanced understanding of divine-human interaction in the context of petitionary prayer, situating it within a broader theological discourse.

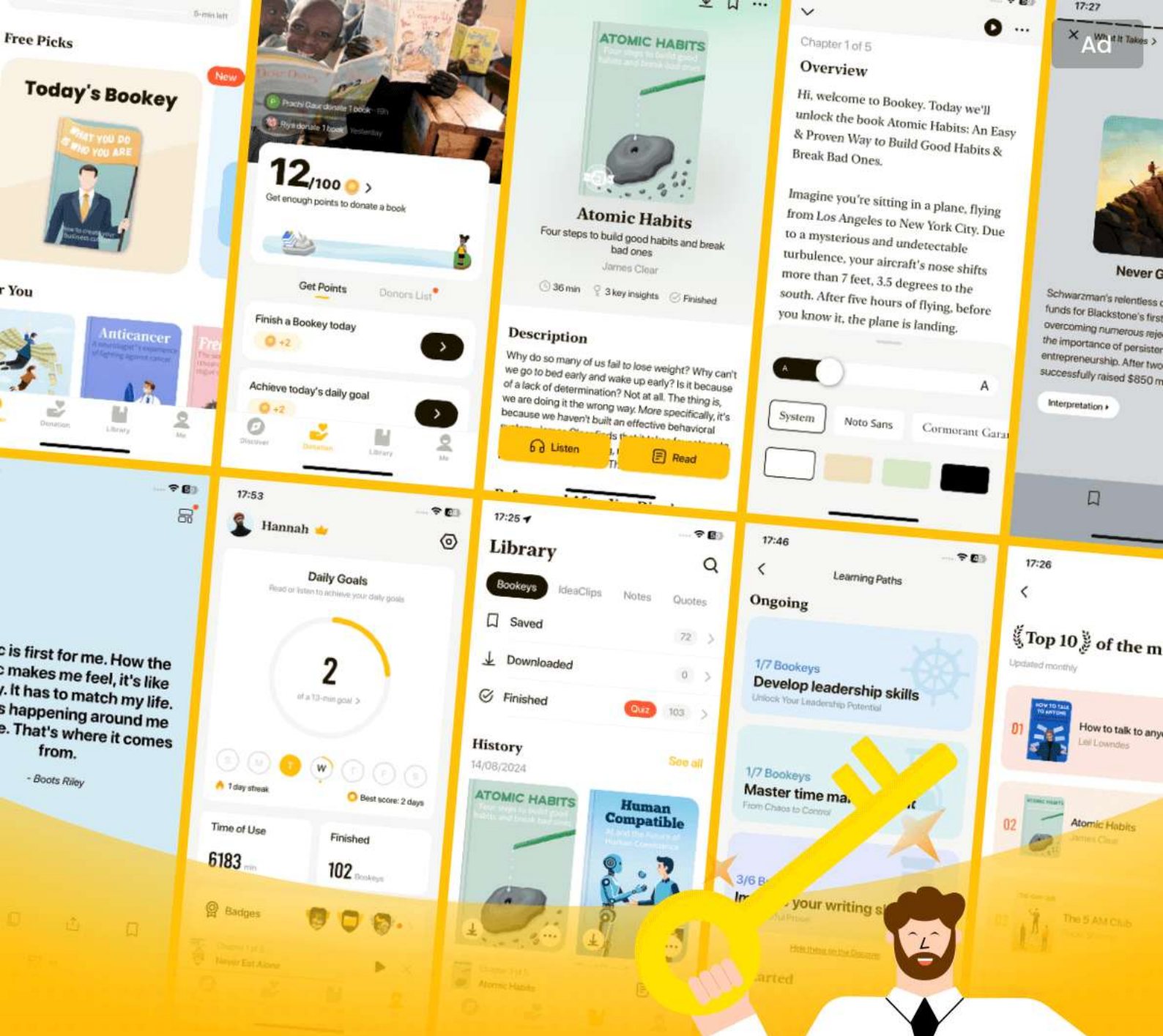
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# Best Quotes from Metaphysics by William Hasker with Page Numbers

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## Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 569-638

1. In fact, God is enormous. More than that, God is really tremendous.
2. The universe has outgrown the anthropomorphic one-planet deity.
3. We really do believe that the One who creates, and sustains, and energizes the entirety of this impossibly huge universe has chosen—amazingly—to take an interest in us, to care for us, to redeem us from our sins and make us his own children.
4. Divine immensity is only a first step on the way towards a 'big enough' God, one who is adequate for our needs in the present moment.
5. It is your God—the God so obsessed with total control that he is unable or unwilling to allow any other being any role in determining what happens in the world—it is this God

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who is too small.

## Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 639-745

1. We need to recognize that God is very, very big. In fact, God is enormous. More than that, God is really tremendous. In traditional theology, one of the attributes of God was said to be immensity, and that is just right: God is truly immense.
2. We really do believe that the One who creates, and sustains, and energizes the entirety of this impossibly huge universe has chosen—amazingly—to take an interest in us, to care for us, to redeem us from our sins and make us his own children.
3. Divine immensity is only a first step on the way towards a 'big enough' God, one who is adequate for our needs in the present moment.
4. It is your God—the God so obsessed with total control that he is unable or unwilling to allow any other being any role in determining what happens in the world—it is this God who is too small.

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- 5.I propose that we should proceed by thinking of 'bigness' in personal terms—that we should ask ourselves what we have in mind when we speak of a 'big' human being.
- 6.If we agree that these are indeed the qualities of a big person and a great leader, and that our understanding of the character of God should be modeled on them, then I submit that there is one particular way of conceiving of God that best fills the bill. This is the view that has recently come to be known as 'open theism.'
- 7.A truly great leader, we think, does not micromanage her subordinates in such a way as to remove their own scope for initiative and creativity; rather, she develops these qualities in them and seeks to harness them for the greater good of the whole.
- 8.But to be sure, there is much in the way the world progresses that does not at all seem to us as though it is the way things would have been decided by an all-determining God who is also perfectly good and loving.
- 9.Open theists will have a similar attitude about certain



theories, but for rather different reasons. Unlike Einstein, open theists reject universal, deterministic causation.

10.If one has a justified belief in an open rather than determined future, then one should hold on and see if physics will one day catch up.

### **Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 746-819**

- 1.Science is made up of more than observations and laws. Scientists, like the rest of us, rely on a whole host of unarticulated assumptions about the world and how it ought to be studied.
- 2.The irony is that Kuhn himself was not a conceptual relativist.
- 3.MSPs lie at the heart of many theology-and-science debates.
- 4.One reason John Polkinghorne rejects panentheism is that it is a more radical change than is needed to correct the problems of Augustinian-Calvinist thought.
- 5.If the best explanation for some phenomenon is design, even supernatural design, that would still count as a

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scientific explanation.

- 6.If one has a justified belief in an open rather than determined future, then one should hold on and see if physics will one day catch up.
- 7.The science-theology 'dialogue' should be a two-way street, rather than, as is tacitly demanded, the dictation of scientific authority to the softer discourse of faith.
- 8.There are relatively few distinctive doctrines held by the entire group. Consequently, the relation between open theology and science... depends more on these intramural differences than openness itself.

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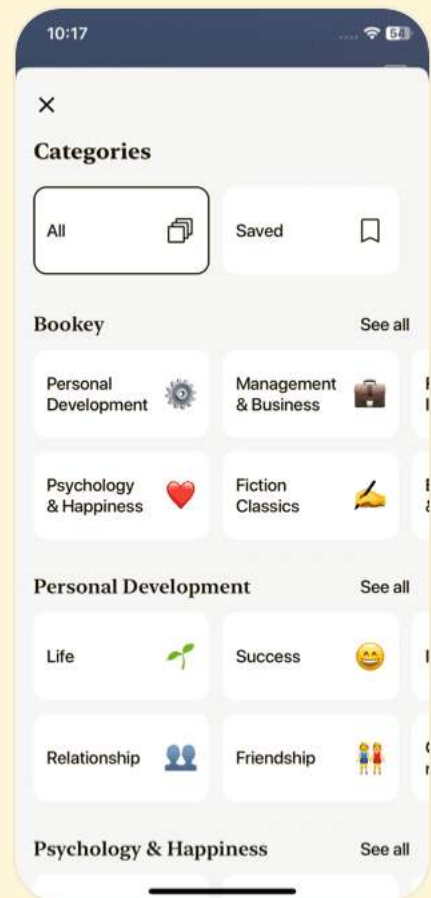
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## Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 820-966

1. One of the positive effects of Structure was to help us see that science is made up of more than observations and laws.
2. MSPs help determine what good theories, laws, and models look like as well as how one should proceed in their discovery and development.
3. First, like everything else in science, MSPs can be trumped in particular circumstances and sometimes rejected outright.
4. If one has a justified belief in an open rather than determined future, then one should hold on and see if physics will one day catch up.
5. The best that the proponents of any perspective can do, given the Kantian hypothesis in question, is to justifiably believe (for various reasons) that this perspective is superior.
6. We have good reason to encourage dialogue with others, even if my Kantian hypothesis is true.

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## Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 967-1041

- 1.No one denies that belief, in general, is influenced by a number of factors outside of our control.
- 2.It seems rather to be primarily the result of the absorption of the pacifistic view of the world that becomes subconsciously ingrained (soft-wired) into the Mennonite child after birth.
- 3.The normal functioning of our brain is not to proportion belief to the totality of the evidence but rather to make judgments in specific situations apart from all of relevant data of which we are aware.
- 4.While the normal functioning of the brain strongly favors belief retention, conscious reflection on beliefs can result in belief modification.
- 5.The most accurate and useful way to understand religious belief formation/retention is to assume that... our choice of options are significantly shaped by our genetic predispositions, our subconscious cultural conditioning...
- 6.To the extent that we believe we have religious

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belief-forming faculties that can be considered successfully truth-seeking under identifiable conditions... we are likely to believe that we are getting closer and closer to an understanding of religious reality as it really is.

## **Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 1042-1153**

1. The shape of things to come is not fully given in advance... things are progressively 'taking shape' as events unfold, as choices are made, as contingencies become resolved one way or the other.
2. Having a world with an open future requires a degree of openness in God... God's knowledge and experience of the world must change to accurately reflect changes in the world.
3. If the future is causally open, then it is open in all five senses.
4. The story is only partially written... the shape of things to come is, in some respects at least, yet to be decided.
5. If the future is epistemically open, then it must be open in

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all of the other four senses.

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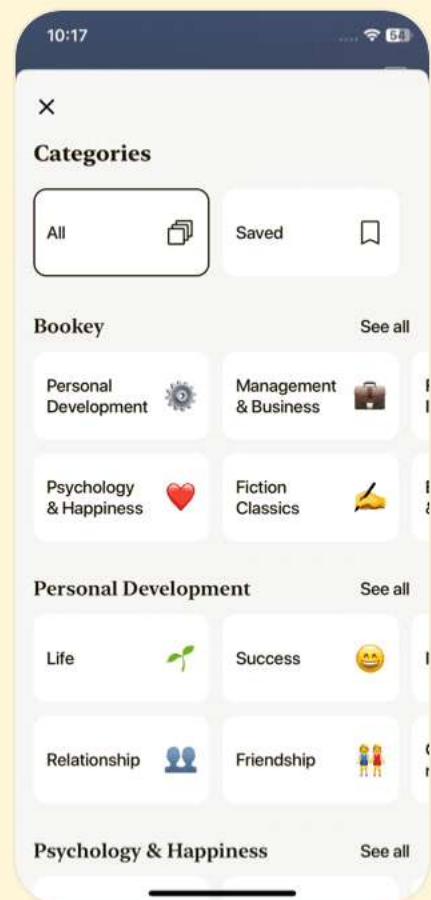
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## Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 1154-1405

1. The shape of things to come is not fully given in advance. Instead, things are progressively 'taking shape' as events unfold, as choices are made, as contingencies become resolved one way or the other.
2. God freely enters into dynamic, ongoing, two-way relations with his creation.
3. A world with an open future requires a degree of openness in God.
4. The future is causally open relative to time  $t$  if and only if there is more than one causally possible future relative to  $t$ .
5. If causal openness entails openness in the other respects, then open theism is the only viable form of free will theism.

## Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 1406-1686

1. . . . one can extract only so much metaphysics from a physical theory as one puts in." —Lawrence Sklar

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2. A noticeable consequence of this commitment is that Open Theists affirm that the future is open in the sense that in many cases what will occur is not specifically foreordained by God, but is also the result of the free acts of humans.
3. Presentism must reject the idea that there is a single, complete and presently existing future.
4. The present then is relative to the observer and not a feature of the nature of time itself.
5. In Minkowski spacetime, there is no distinguished partition of spacetime into space and time, and no observer-independent notion of simultaneity.
6. How does this avoid problems that lead to the conclusion that the past, present, and future are on an ontological par?
7. The present must coincide with the planes of simultaneity of some frame of reference; but which one is not a matter of natural law, but a matter settled by contingent facts about the initial conditions of the universe.
8. Presentism requires that the manifold come with a built-in division into a series of 'slices,' each consisting of the



three-dimensional universe-at-an-instant.

9.The A-theorist must add something to the Minkowskian manifold.

## **Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 1687-1884**

- 1.The A-theorist posits an objective distinction between past, present, and future; there is a fact of the matter about what is really happening, and what is merely past or future, and this fact is not merely relative to a time.
- 2.Presentism is the thesis that only what is present exists or is real, that 'the present simply is the real considered in relation to two particular species of unreality, namely the past and the future.'
- 3.Faith is closely connected with Love... Arguably, this sort of faith is at the heart of love of other people, which involves discerning and affirming the unrealized potentials of oneself and other people for becoming whom God created them to be.
- 4.A major question immediately arises for Stump's account

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with regard to unanswered prayer. In the co-creator model, prayer becomes a way that we can contribute to the well-being of others and ourselves in a way that transcends our normal bodily powers and in a way that explicitly involves God.

5. The type of faith involved in prayer involves envisioning as yet unrealized possibilities... This capacity, central to everyday life, reflects God's call for us to creatively engage with the world.

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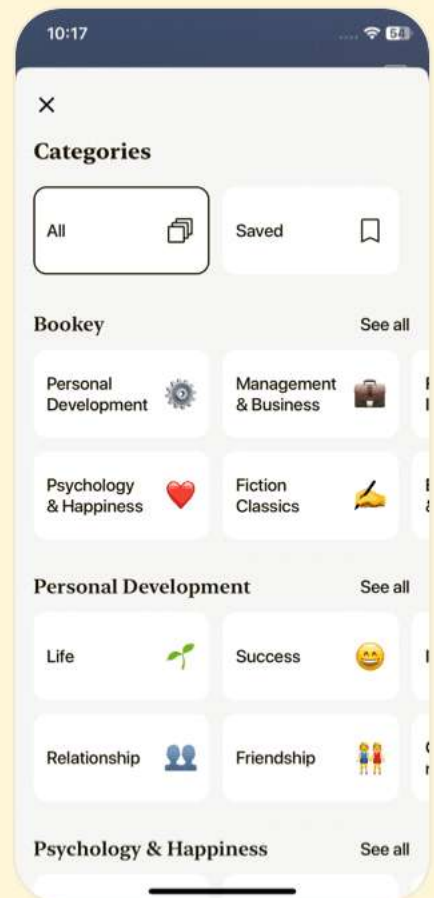
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## Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 1885-1998

- 1.The basic idea behind the co-creator model is that for those cases in which petitionary prayer is efficacious, humans and God work together to help bring about the states of affairs for which we pray.
- 2.If you abide in me, and my words abide in you, ask whatever you wish, and it will be done for you.
- 3.Persistence and faith are typically required for efficacious prayer.
- 4.The connection building theodicy can explain why prayer requires persistence: if prayer required little effort or persistence on our part, then there would be little appreciation from others for helping them via our prayers, since so little effort would have been required.
- 5....prayer creates openings for God or his emissaries to act in the world and that bad intentions and unbelief create barriers...

## Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 1999-2150

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1. The basic idea behind the co-creator model is that for those cases in which petitionary prayer is efficacious, humans and God work together to help bring about the states of affairs for which we pray.
2. The kind of faith and persistence needed for effectual prayer only comes from a dynamic interaction with God—it is the faith of Christ.
3. Prayer becomes a way that we can contribute to the well-being of others and ourselves in a way that transcends our normal bodily powers and in a way that explicitly involves God.
4. Despite its strengths, for those who take scripture seriously the naturalistic understanding does not seem adequate. In scripture, prayer is typically portrayed as being offered to God, with God 'answering' our prayer by acting on our behalf.
5. To correct these problems, one could combine this naturalistic model with a model in which God is directly



involved in the answering of our prayers.

6. Effective petitionary prayer presupposes the prayer of communion with God and 'abiding in Christ.'

7. God is the common cause of both the prayer and its answer, and thus Jane's praying can no more be said to make a difference in whether Jane was healed than the barometric pressure's falling can be said to make a difference in whether it rained.

8. As it says in 1 Cor 13:13, 'And now faith, hope, and love abide, these three; and the greatest of these is love.'

9. The universe is constructed in some deep and subtle way to be responsive to human intentions... just as the body is responsive to our thoughts, as in the case of the placebo effect.

10. Faith is closely connected with Love. This aspect of faith is directed toward other people and involves discerning and affirming the unrealized potentials of oneself and other people for becoming whom God created them to be.

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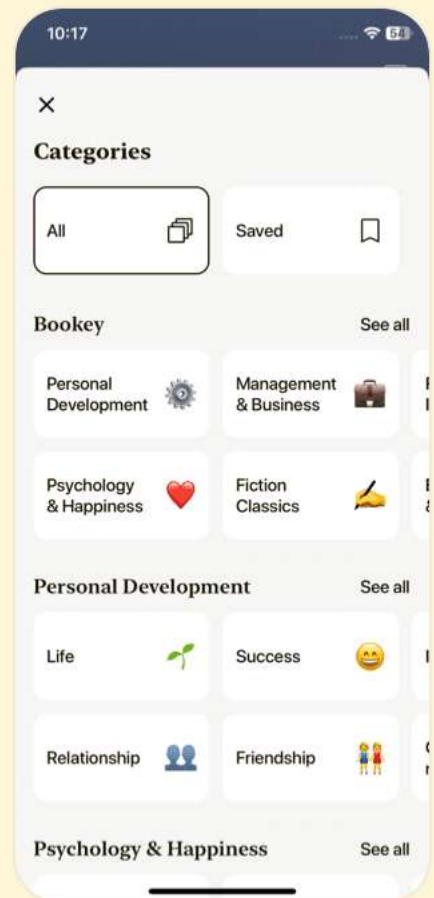
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# Metaphysics Questions

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## Chapter 1 | Part One: Open Theism and the Greatness of God| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What does the author suggest is fundamentally necessary for a contemporary understanding of God?**

Answer:The author suggests that we need a 'bigger God' that transcends traditional and overly restrictive conceptions of divinity. This includes recognizing God's immensity and the importance of understanding Him in personal terms, akin to the qualities that define a 'big' human being.

### 2.Question

**How does the author critique traditional conceptions of God?**

Answer:The author critiques traditional conceptions, such as the 'resident policeman' or 'parental hangover,' for being small and reductive. These views fail to capture the loving, expansive nature of God who is actively involved in the

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universe's ongoing narrative.

### 3.Question

**What is the significance of open theism according to the text?**

Answer:Open theism is significant because it posits that God allows for genuine independence and decision-making in human beings. This perspective reframes God's omnipotence not as micromanagement but as a partnership with creation, where divine risk plays a role in the unfolding of personal and cosmic history.

### 4.Question

**Why does the author argue that the standard theological deterministic view of God is 'too small'?**

Answer:The author argues that the deterministic view of God, which maintains absolute control over every decision and outcome, does not align with a God who embodies the attributes of a great human leader. Such a God would desire to allow creatures a measure of freedom and autonomy, rather than prevent any independent decision-making.

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## 5.Question

**What analogy does the author use to explain God's desired relationship with creation?**

Answer:The author uses the analogy of a robot to illustrate God's desire for creation to have autonomy. Unlike a simple robot with predetermined commands, God desires a 'Commander Data' type of creation, which possesses sophistication, agency, and the ability to make meaningful contributions to the divine project.

## 6.Question

**What relationship does the author propose between open theism and evolutionary cosmology?**

Answer:The author proposes that open theism naturally aligns with an evolutionary cosmology, as both recognize a dynamic, self-creative universe where entities—both human and non-human—possess a degree of autonomy and the capacity for development and complexity.

## 7.Question

**What are the implications of the emergent view of the soul that the author discusses?**

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Answer: The emergent view of the soul implies that the soul is not merely a static component but develops organically through complex processes, reflecting changes in consciousness and self-awareness. This view supports the idea of continuous growth and evolution within creation, including human identity.

### 8.Question

**How does the author challenge the materialist view of consciousness?**

Answer: The author challenges the materialist view by arguing that experiences of consciousness involve more than just brain processes. He posits that if neural activities were the sole determinants of decisions and reasoning, the rationale behind coherent thoughts would be inexplicable, suggesting that consciousness must possess causal powers that influence physical processes.

### 9.Question

**What conclusion does the author reach about the interconnectedness of open theism, evolutionary cosmology, and the emergent theory of the soul?**

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Answer: The author concludes that these three concepts—open theism, an evolutionary cosmology, and an emergent view of the soul—together offer a robust and coherent understanding of God and humanity. They form a comprehensive worldview that is capable of meeting the spiritual needs of contemporary believers.

## **Chapter 2 | The Need for a Bigger God| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**What does Hasker mean by 'A Bigger God' and why do we need it?**

Answer: Hasker argues that many contemporary views of God are overly simplistic or 'small', resembling caricatures such as the 'resident policeman' or 'parental hangover'. He believes we require a more comprehensive understanding of God that acknowledges His immense nature and the vast universe we inhabit. By recognizing a 'bigger' God, we can address pressing questions in Christian philosophy and theology and understand the divine's

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concern for humanity amidst the universe's enormity.

## 2.Question

**What are the consequences of limiting God to a 'one-planet deity'?**

Answer:Limiting God to a 'one-planet deity' confines our understanding of divine involvement to only what impacts Earth. Hasker suggests this view neglects the massive universe and God's role within it, potentially leading to skepticism about God's relevance and presence in the broader cosmos. This perspective could diminish the spiritual significance of God's involvement in individual lives.

## 3.Question

**How does contemporary science contribute to our understanding of God?**

Answer:Contemporary science reveals an unimaginably vast universe, suggesting that our understanding of God must expand to coincide with scientific discoveries. This broad scientific perspective invites us to reject narrow views of

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God and engage with concepts like divine care for all of creation, despite humanity's seemingly insignificant place in the cosmos.

#### 4.Question

**What personal qualities are associated with being a 'big person' in the context of understanding God?**

Answer:Hasker connects the concept of a 'big person' to qualities such as strength, wisdom, reliability, and generosity. He argues that to understand God's character, we should think of divine attributes in terms of these admirable human qualities, which enhance our comprehension of a 'big enough' God—one who can adequately address human needs and concerns.

#### 5.Question

**What is the view of 'open theism' as presented by Hasker?**

Answer:Open theism posits that God grants individuals genuine autonomy in their decision-making, thereby allowing for real risks and uncertainties in the world.

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According to Hasker, this view emphasizes God's relational engagement with humanity, presents a proactive divine involvement in the world, and rejects the deterministic viewpoint that nullifies human freedom.

## 6.Question

**How does Hasker differentiate between open theism and deterministic views of God?**

Answer:Hasker contrasts open theism with deterministic views, which assert that God predetermines every event, including human choices. Open theism allows for real freedom, meaning that individuals can make decisions that may diverge from divine plans, thereby highlighting God's responsiveness and relationality in interactions with His creation.

## 7.Question

**What implications does Hasker draw from the acceptance of an evolutionary cosmology in relation to God?**

Answer:Hasker suggests that embracing an evolutionary cosmology aligns with open theism, as it acknowledges a

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dynamic creation where entities, including humans, possess inherent powers and capacities for self-development. This supports the idea of a God who desires creation to operate autonomously while still sustaining it, reflecting divine benevolence through the process of evolution.

### 8.Question

**How does Hasker argue for the emergence of the soul in relation to open theism?**

Answer:Hasker argues that if God desires to create beings that are genuinely 'Other' than Himself, this includes the emergence of personhood, or the soul, through natural processes. He suggests that the soul may arise from complex configurations of the brain rather than being a pre-created substance, thus supporting a view compatible with evolutionary theories.

### 9.Question

**What challenges does Hasker identify for theism when integrating with modern science?**

Answer:Hasker identifies challenges such as the influence of

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methodological naturalism, which can limit scientific inquiry to natural explanations and may lead to a worldview that excludes supernatural involvement. He also discusses ontological reductionism, where mental states are viewed solely as brain states, contradicting theistic beliefs in the existence of the soul and spiritual entities.

### 10.Question

**What is Hasker's perspective on the relationship between theology and science?**

Answer:Hasker advocates for a reciprocal dialogue between theology and science, where both can influence each other. He argues that theological insights can provide valuable perspectives on scientific inquiries, especially regarding the nature of God, free will, and the workings of creation, thus enriching both fields.

## Chapter 3 | Part Two: Science and Open Theism| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What are metatheoretic shaping principles (MSPs), and why are they significant in the relationship between**

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## **science and theology?**

Answer:Metatheoretic shaping principles (MSPs) encompass the underlying philosophical assumptions that guide scientific inquiry and theories. They are significant because these principles influence how science is conducted and interpreted, particularly regarding the interaction between scientific findings and theological beliefs. MSPs can determine what is considered valid knowledge and can shape theological positions, especially in discussions on topics like creationism and intelligent design.

## **2.Question**

**How do MSPs contribute to the debate between theism and metaphysical naturalism?**

Answer:MSPs highlight the conflicting assumptions between theistic beliefs and metaphysical naturalism, which often assumes that all phenomena can be explained by natural laws without involving divine action. For example, the principle

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of causal closure suggests that every physical event must have a sufficient physical cause, making room for tension with the idea of a supernatural being influencing events.

### 3.Question

**In what ways are scientific theories shaped by metatheoretic principles, and how do they evolve over time?**

Answer:Scientific theories are shaped by MSPs through the methodologies deemed acceptable, the types of explanations pursued, and the foundational assumptions about nature and causality. These principles evolve over time as new discoveries are made and paradigms shift, often requiring revisions in both scientific theories and the underlying philosophical approaches. Historical cases, such as the transition from catastrophism to uniformitarianism in geology, illustrate how MSPs can be reassessed in light of new evidence.

### 4.Question

**What is methodological naturalism (MN), and why do some theologians accept it?**

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Answer:Methodological naturalism (MN) is the approach where scientists limit their explanations to natural causes and laws, intentionally setting aside supernatural explanations. Some theologians accept MN because it allows for scientific inquiry without religious bias, maintaining that science can effectively explore nature without descending into metaphysical debates. However, they also recognize the potential risks of MN leading to a form of philosophical naturalism.

### 5.Question

**How does open theism relate to scientific MSPs, and what tensions exist?**

Answer:Open theism posits that the future is not entirely predetermined and that human beings have genuine free will. This view contrasts with scientific and philosophical deterministic models, leading to potential tensions with MSPs like universal causation and scientific realism. Open theists may adopt anti-realist positions towards theories that imply a fixed future, thereby allowing space for human

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agency and divine action.

## 6.Question

**Why is there a limited number of tensions between open theism and MSPs?**

Answer: The limited number of tensions arises because both open and classical theism share many scientific assumptions and insights. In particular, both perspectives can support various interpretations of scientific theories without pushing for radically differing epistemologies. Furthermore, open theism itself is broad and does not impose a singular restrictive view, allowing for diverse interpretations of divine action and engagement with scientific findings.

## 7.Question

**What implication does the statement "the science-theology dialogue should be a two-way street" have for the relationship between science and faith?**

Answer: This statement implies that both science and theology should influence each other reciprocally, suggesting that scientific discoveries can inform theological understanding, and vice versa. It promotes an ongoing

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conversation where faith and reason coexist and contribute to a broader comprehension of reality, rather than positioning science as the sole authority over matters of truth.

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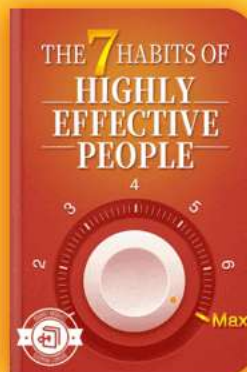
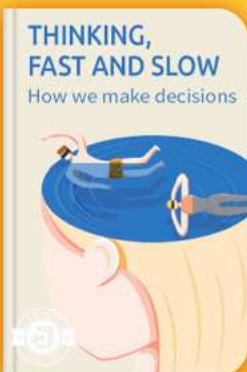


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## Chapter 4 | Metatheoretic Shaping Principles| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What are metatheoretic shaping principles (MSPs) and why are they important in the relationship between science and theology?**

Answer:MSPs are foundational principles that guide how scientific theories and models are developed and understood. They encompass both metaphysical assumptions, like the uniformity of nature, and epistemic norms, such as reliance on repeatable observations. Understanding MSPs is crucial as they demonstrate the interplay between science and theology, indicating how scientific developments can influence theological perspectives and vice versa.

### 2.Question

**How has the perception of the role of scientists changed since Kuhn's work, particularly in relation to observations and theories?**

Answer:Before Kuhn, scientists were often viewed as objective observers of nature. Kuhn's work highlighted that

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scientists operate under numerous unarticulated assumptions and that their interpretations of data are influenced by prevailing paradigms. This recognition shifted the understanding of scientific inquiry to acknowledge that data and theories are intertwined, with observations being influenced by theoretical frameworks.

### 3.Question

**In what ways do MSPs relate to the debate between ID (Intelligent Design) advocates and their critics?**

Answer:MSPs play a vital role in the ID debate as they determine how scientific legitimacy is framed. Advocates often argue from a theistic ontology, allowing them to accept ID without a radical shift in their worldview. In contrast, critics, usually coming from a naturalistic perspective, find it challenging to accommodate theistic explanations without expanding their existing metaphysics, showcasing a tension instead of a straightforward empirical conflict.

### 4.Question

**What is methodological naturalism (MN) and how does it impact the practice of science?**

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Answer:MN is a principle that asserts science should only consider naturalistic explanations for phenomena, effectively excluding supernatural considerations from scientific inquiry. This viewpoint can lead to tensions for theists, as it suggests that true scientific explanations must be naturalistic, which can conflict with beliefs that include supernatural elements or divine action.

### 5.Question

**How does open theism interact with current scientific theories and frameworks?**

Answer:Open theism posits that the future is not fully determined and that free will plays a significant role in human action. This viewpoint can create tension with deterministic interpretations of scientific theories, such as relativity and quantum mechanics, that suggest a fixed future. Open theists may adopt anti-realist stances towards theories that imply a predetermined future, advocating instead for a model that allows for human agency and divine interaction.

### 6.Question

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## **Why is it significant to recognize that MSPs and their interpretation can change over time?**

Answer: The recognition that MSPs evolve is significant because it suggests that scientific understanding is not static. Historical examples, like the shift from catastrophism to uniformitarianism in geology, illustrate how changing paradigms can reflect new evidence or shifts in thought. This fluidity implies that current doctrines in science, metaphysics, or theology may also be reconsidered in light of future discoveries or insights.

## **7.Question**

### **What implications does the author suggest arise from the interplay between science and theology?**

Answer: The author suggests that theological beliefs can inform scientific inquiries and vice versa, allowing for a richer dialogue that acknowledges the legitimacy of various viewpoints. This interaction encourages an exploration of beliefs while also advocating for a humility in claiming certainty about religious truths, recognizing that our

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understanding is shaped by cultural and cognitive factors.

### 8.Question

**Can modern scientific advances ever outweigh established theological perspectives?**

Answer:The interplay is complex. While scientific advances can challenge theological views, especially regarding the nature and age of the universe, they often do not wholly overturn faith-based beliefs. Instead, they prompt reevaluation and adaptation within theological frameworks as individuals seek to harmonize scientific findings with their spiritual understandings.

### 9.Question

**How does the author view the role of human agency in forming and retaining religious beliefs?**

Answer:The author posits that while individuals possess libertarian freedom to choose their beliefs, this freedom is significantly influenced by genetic predispositions, cultural conditioning, and early teachings. As such, even acts of free will in belief formation are shaped by factors often outside

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individual control and consciousness.

### 10.Question

**What challenge does the author raise about the ability to claim knowledge of religious truth?**

Answer:The author challenges the idea that individuals can objectively determine that their religious beliefs are true. The diversity of beliefs among knowledgeable and sincere individuals suggests that one's belief may be justifiable but not absolute. This calls for an acknowledgment of the limitations imposed by personal and cultural influences on our understanding of religious truth.

## Chapter 5 | Religious Belief Formation| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What are the main factors that influence religious belief formation according to David Basinger?**

Answer:1. **\*\*Genetic Factors\*\***: Studies indicate that genetic traits can influence our capacity for inquiry, acceptance of authority, and dogmatism, all of which affect how we form and retain religious

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beliefs.

2. **Cultural Conditioning**: Our beliefs are significantly shaped by the cultural environments we are raised in, often absorbed subconsciously rather than through direct teaching.

3. **Early Teaching by Authority Figures**: Influences from parents, pastors, and teachers play a critical role, often shaping our religious understanding from a young age, even if we later believe our beliefs are based solely on personal study.

4. **Brain Function**: The way our brain processes information leads us to filter beliefs through preconceptions, making us less likely to change our beliefs even when presented with contradictory evidence.

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## 2.Question

**How does Basinger's Kantian hypothesis relate to the justification of religious beliefs?**

Answer:Basinger's Kantian hypothesis suggests that, while individuals may hold religious beliefs justifiably, there is no objective, non-question-begging way to prove that one's religious perspective is superior to another's. He posits that belief formation is heavily influenced by genetic, cultural, and environmental factors, meaning our ability to assert that our belief-forming faculties function correctly is compromised. Thus, we can believe our perspectives are justified, but we cannot demonstrate their superiority objectively.

## 3.Question

**What practical implications arise from accepting Basinger's Kantian hypothesis on belief formation?**

Answer:1. **\*\*Educational Approaches\*\***: Instructing future generations on religious issues should involve presenting multiple perspectives fairly and impartially, acknowledging

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that all can be considered justified in their own right.

2. **\*\*Promotion of Tolerance\*\***: Encouraging individuals to reflect on their beliefs and the influences shaping them can lead to greater respect for differing perspectives, potentially reducing religious intolerance.

3. **\*\*Understanding Belief Modification\*\***: Recognizing that beliefs can evolve over time suggests that individuals should engage in reflection and dialogue about their beliefs, which may facilitate personal growth and the reassessment of entrenched views.

#### 4.Question

**What role does brain function play in belief retention and modification according to Basinger?**

Answer:Basinger asserts that our brain typically favors belief retention over belief modification. Our emotional attachments to beliefs, coupled with the brain's filtering of information in line with currently held beliefs, makes it

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difficult to accept new information that contradicts these beliefs. This cognitive bias leads to a strong predisposition to maintain core beliefs over one's lifetime. However, conscious reflection can trigger shifts in perspective when individuals are made aware of inconsistencies in their beliefs, potentially leading to belief modification.

### 5.Question

**What does Basinger imply about the future of religious beliefs and their perceived validity?**

Answer:Basinger indicates that many religious beliefs that seem self-evident today may not appear as such to future generations. He argues that beliefs are shaped by the prevailing cultural and psychological contexts, suggesting that our current understanding of religious truths might be seen as flawed or naïve in the light of future insights and societal changes. Thus, it is likely that some of the beliefs we hold today as clearly justified may be questioned or rejected by future adherents of the same beliefs.

**Chapter 6 | Part Three: Open Theism, Time, and**

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# Relativity| Q&A

## 1.Question

**What does it mean for the future to be 'causally open'?**

Answer:The future is causally open if there are multiple possible outcomes that could occur, meaning that not everything is determined by past events and the laws of nature. This implies that there are genuine choices and contingencies that can lead to different future states.

## 2.Question

**How is the openness of God related to the concept of an open future?**

Answer:The openness of God refers to His capacity to engage in dynamic relationships with creation. For there to be a genuinely open future where outcomes are not predetermined, God must also be open to the influences and choices of His creatures, allowing for a meaningful interplay of free will.

## 3.Question

**What are the five distinct senses in which the future is**

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## **considered 'open'?**

Answer: The future can be considered open in the following five senses:

1. **Causal Openness**: Multiple causally possible futures exist.
2. **Ontic Openness**: The world state does not necessarily lead to a unique series of future states.
3. **Alethic Openness**: There is no 'complete true story' of the future that is fully determined.
4. **Epistemic Openness**: The state of future events is not known infallibly, meaning that knowledge of them remains indeterminate.
5. **Providential Openness**: Events have not been predetermined or ordained in a way that guarantees one outcome.

## **4.Question**

**Why is 'causal openness' considered a widely accepted notion?**

Answer: Causal openness is often accepted because it aligns

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with the understanding of indeterminism, especially in the context of quantum mechanics, which suggests that certain events are not fully predictable. Many proponents of libertarian free will also affirm this view, as it allows for genuine choice.

### 5.Question

**How does the idea of symmetry principles contribute to the understanding of openness in the future?**

Answer:Symmetry principles imply that if one sense of openness (like causal) is accepted, then the others (ontic, alethic, epistemic, and providential) must also be accepted or vice versa. This interconnectedness helps to establish a coherent view of open theism, where accepting one aspect of openness strengthens the argument for the others.

### 6.Question

**What implications arise if the future is deemed 'epistemically open'?**

Answer:If the future is epistemically open, it means that no one, including God, can possess infallible knowledge

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regarding future events. This challenges traditional views of divine foreknowledge and suggests a dynamic relationship between God's knowledge and the unfolding events of creation.

### 7.Question

**What is the significance of identifying the future as 'ontically open'?**

Answer:If the future is ontically open, it suggests that there is no fixed or predetermined series of future events. This has implications for how we understand time, change, and God's relationship to creation, fostering the view that the future is not merely an extension of the past.

### 8.Question

**How does the perspective of open theism differ from theological determinism?**

Answer:Open theism posits that the future is dynamic and not fully known or determined, allowing for genuine human freedom and unpredictability. In contrast, theological determinism asserts that all events, including human actions,

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are predetermined by God, leaving no room for an open future.

### 9.Question

**What challenges do non-open theists face regarding the concept of divine foreknowledge?**

Answer:Non-open theists must reconcile the idea of a God who possesses complete foreknowledge while also maintaining that the future is fixed. This creates tension regarding human freedom, as true freedom implies the ability to affect future outcomes in a way that is not fully known in advance.

### 10.Question

**In what ways could accepting causal openness affect a theist's view on providential guidance from God?**

Answer:If a theist accepts causal openness, they must consider that God's providential guidance does not necessarily involve meticulously determining every detail of the future. It suggests a model where God interacts with creation dynamically, allowing for genuine choice while still

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guiding overall outcomes.

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## Chapter 7 | The Fivefold Openness of the Future| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What makes Open Theism distinct from traditional views of God and the future?**

Answer:Open Theism emphasizes that the future is not predetermined and is still being shaped by the choices of beings within creation. Unlike classical theism, which often holds that God knows the future exhaustively and that all events are settled, Open Theism presents God as engaging in a dynamic and relational process with creation, where the future remains open and influenced by human actions.

### 2.Question

**What are the five senses of openness defined in the context of the future?**

Answer:1. Causal Openness: The future has multiple causally possible outcomes based on past events and choices. 2. Ontic Openness: The existence of future world states is not fixed or predetermined. 3. Alethic Openness: There is no singular true

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story of the future that dictates what must come to pass. 4.

Epistemic Openness: The future cannot be infallibly known by anyone, including God. 5. Providential Openness: The future is not meticulously ordained by God, allowing for genuine human freedom and influence over future events.

### 3.Question

**How does the notion of time differ between Open Theism and traditional theistic views?**

Answer:Open Theism posits that God exists within time, meaning that God experiences events in a sequential manner, just as humans do. This contrasts with traditional views that may argue for divine timelessness or an atemporal understanding of God's existence. As a result, the future in Open Theism is truly open, allowing for the unfolding of events based on free will, whereas traditional views might see the future as already known and settled.

### 4.Question

**What implications does causal openness have for the concepts of free will and divine providence within Open Theism?**

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Answer:Causal openness suggests that if the future is genuinely open, then divine providence must also allow for human free will. This means that God does not determine every event but rather permits a level of freedom that allows individuals to make choices that shape the unfolding of the future. This reconciles human freedom with God's sovereignty by presenting a God who works within the dynamic relationships of creation.

## 5.Question

**What challenges does Open Theism face concerning its compatibility with contemporary physics, particularly relativity and notions of time?**

Answer:Open Theism must grapple with the implications of theories like relativity which suggest a non-linear understanding of time and simultaneity. Relativity posits that time may not be absolute and that events may not be simultaneous across different inertial frames of reference. This raises questions for Open Theism about how a dynamic, unfolding future can coexist with scientific views that

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challenge traditional notions of timeline and causality.

## 6.Question

**In what way does presentism relate to Open Theism, and what defense does it offer?**

Answer:Presentism, which holds that only the present exists, aligns well with Open Theism's view of a dynamic future where possibilities are created through choices. Presentism defends the relevance and significance of the present moment, reinforcing the belief that past and future events do not have existence on par with present reality. This can provide a philosophical grounding for Open Theism, suggesting that God's relationship with creation is engaged in the ongoing present rather than an eternal past or future.

## 7.Question

**What theoretical approach does the author propose to reconcile presentism with the implications of special relativity?**

Answer:The author suggests a relationalist view of time, where the concept of the present is defined through the relationships between existing entities, allowing for a flexible

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understanding of simultaneity. This approach maintains that while the future is not fixed and entirely open, it can still be compatible with the empirical results of relativity without necessitating a fully eternalist perspective on spacetime.

## 8.Question

**How does the author argue against the notion that Minkowski spacetime necessitates eternalism?**

Answer: The author argues that the empirical success of relativity theory does not inherently require an eternalist interpretation. Instead, the geometric representation of Minkowski spacetime can be viewed as a valuable but not ontological claim. By treating spacetime relationally, one can affirm the findings of relativity without accepting that past, present, and future are equally real, thus maintaining the open and dynamic aspect of time that Open Theism emphasizes.

## Chapter 8 | Presentism and the Problem of Special Relativity| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is Presentism, and how does it differ from**

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## **Eternalism?**

Answer: Presentism is the philosophical thesis that only the present exists, claiming that past and future events do not have the same ontological status as present events. Eternalism, in contrast, posits that past, present, and future events are equally real, framing time as a fourth dimension analogous to space, where all points in time exist on the same ontological plane.

### **2.Question**

**What intuitive appeal does Presentism offer to supporters compared to Eternalism?**

Answer: Presentism captures our common experience of time, emphasizing the uniqueness of the present moment. It aligns with our understanding of existence as dynamic and changing, whereas Eternalism can feel counterintuitive as it suggests the past and future are just as 'real' as the present.

### **3.Question**

**What criticisms does Presentism face from supporters of**

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## **Relativity?**

Answer: Critics argue that Presentism contradicts the principles of Special Relativity, which shows that simultaneity is relative to an observer's frame of reference, thus challenging the notion of an absolute present. Critics claim that if the present is not an unchanging, universal concept, then how can it be meaningful in the context of a four-dimensional spacetime.

### **4.Question**

**How does David M. Woodruff respond to the criticisms against Presentism in relation to Special Relativity?**

Answer: Woodruff asserts that it is possible to accept the empirical findings of Special Relativity without fully adopting its metaphysical implications. He argues that Presentism can coexist with a reconciled version of Relativity by emphasizing a relational approach to spacetime, allowing for a non-absolute interpretation of the present without denying the structured nature of reality.

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## **Can an Open Theist effectively align their views with Presentism, and if so, how?**

Answer: An Open Theist can align with Presentism by affirming that God's interaction with time is dynamic and relational, maintaining that God is aware of the changing reality of events as they become present. This allows them to accept an A-theory of time, where only the present moment is fully real, without compromising their belief in free will and the openness of the future.

### **6.Question**

## **In what way does the defeat of Presentism by Relativity illuminate the debate about the nature of time?**

Answer: The debate highlights fundamental questions about the ontological status of time and existence. If Presentism is rejected based on Relativity, it indicates that our understanding of time must incorporate scientific evidence, challenging purely philosophical intuitions. This tension between experiential notions of time and the scientific framework of Relativity shapes our ongoing inquiry into the

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metaphysics of time.

### 7.Question

**How can proponents of Presentism address the alleged tension between their views and the predictions of physics?**

Answer:Proponents can argue for a relational interpretation of spacetime that does not require a fixed universal present but allows for a series of contemporaneous moments that can coexist with a Minkowskian metric without requiring a substantivalist view of spacetime.

### 8.Question

**What implication does God's knowledge have for the Future according to Open Theists who embrace Presentism?**

Answer:Open Theists contend that because the future is not predetermined and events are not fully known until they happen, this aligns with Presentism's view that only the current reality is real. Hence, while God is omniscient, His knowledge of the future reflects all potential outcomes that remain contingent until actualized.

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## 9.Question

**What is the chief philosophical contention about A-theory and B-theory regarding Presentism?**

Answer: The chief contention lies in whether reality is fundamentally structured by time as tensed (A-theory) or if events exist simply in a temporal order without intrinsic tensed properties (B-theory). Presentism, as a form of A-theory, insists on the uniqueness of the present, which B-theory rejects as it denies any ontological privilege to the present.

## 10.Question

**Why might a philosopher choose to defend Presentism in relation to modern physics?**

Answer: Philosophers may find value in Presentism because it resonates with intuitive notions of time and change, aligns with experiences of temporal flow, and provides a coherent framework for understanding divine interaction and human freedom without being strictly bound by the implications of physical theories like Relativity.

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## Chapter 9 | Open Theism and the Metaphysics of the Space-Time Manifold| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the core argument for Open Theism in relation to the nature of time and God's interaction with it?**

Answer:The core argument for Open Theism, as outlined in Dean Zimmerman's paper, asserts that God exists in time and interacts with creation in a dynamic way. Open Theists advocate for 'A-theories' of time (especially presentism) which posit an objective distinction between past, present, and future, thus making God aware of what events are genuinely present. This model suggests God does not have exhaustive foreknowledge of future free actions, allowing for human freedom and genuine interaction with God.

### 2.Question

**How does the A-theory of time, specifically presentism, address common criticisms based on Special Relativity?**

Answer:Presentism contends that only the present exists and

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the A-theory emphasizes the significance of the present moment. Critics argue that presentism conflicts with Special Relativity, which suggests that simultaneity is relative and doesn't allow for an absolute present. Zimmerman counters this by suggesting that the criticisms are overstated, and that presentists can align their view with certain interpretations of Special Relativity, particularly by positing that God's interaction preserves a form of objective truth within the temporal framework.

### 3.Question

**What role does faith play in the efficacy of petitionary prayer in the Open Theist model?**

Answer: In the Open Theist model, faith is central to the efficacy of prayer. Effective petitionary prayer requires a faith that is profoundly tuned to one's intentions and the divine will, cultivating an openness to God's involvement. It's not merely about making requests; it's about fostering a relationship with God that influences the outcomes aligned with God's purposes in the world.

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#### 4.Question

**How does the co-creator model clarify the purpose and necessity of asking in prayer?**

Answer:The co-creator model posits that asking in prayer embodies a deliberate desire for God to be involved in unfolding the desired outcomes, fostering a dynamic partnership between the divine and human action. This asking is essential as it demonstrates intentionality and openness to divine influence, embodying a relational interdependence that enriches the spiritual journey.

#### 5.Question

**Can prayer affect God's decisions, according to Open Theism? How does this differ from deterministic views?**

Answer:Yes, according to Open Theism, prayer can affect God's decisions because God interacts with humanity in a relational and responsive way. This differs from deterministic views where God's decisions are fixed and unchangeable; in such views, prayer does not influence God's will but may serve other purposes such as spiritual

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discipline. Open Theism asserts that God's knowledge of the future is not exhaustive, allowing for the genuine impact of human choices, including prayers.

## 6.Question

**What implications does the Open Theism view have for understanding unanswered prayers?**

Answer:Open Theism provides several explanations for unanswered prayers. It acknowledges that our lack of faith or persistence can impact prayer efficacy and recognizes that spiritual obstacles can hinder the desired outcomes.

Ultimately, it allows for mystery and the reality that sometimes God's answer may be 'no' or not what is requested, suggesting a complex interplay between divine will and human agency.

## 7.Question

**In what ways does the co-creator model seek to enhance the relational aspect of prayer?**

Answer:The co-creator model enhances the relational aspect of prayer by emphasizing that prayer is not only about

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requests but is a means of inviting God into the process of creation. It fosters mutual dependence, where human intentions and desires engage with divine action, thereby enriching the relationship between individuals and God, characterized by collaboration and shared purpose.

### 8.Question

**How does the concept of faith in the co-creator model relate to personal growth and community well-being?**

Answer:Faith in the co-creator model is seen as a proactive force driving personal growth and community well-being. It inspires individuals to envision possibilities for themselves and others, fostering intimate relationships and mutual support within communities. This vision aligns with the biblical imperative for love and service, emphasizing that our prayers can lead to tangible improvements in ourselves and our communities.

### 9.Question

**What challenges does the paper raise regarding the interpretation of divine omniscience in Open Theism?**

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Answer: The paper suggests that Open Theism challenges traditional interpretations of divine omniscience by positing that God does not possess exhaustive knowledge of future free actions. This raises questions about the nature of God's foreknowledge and the dynamics of divine interaction since it suggests that some propositions related to future events are not true until they occur, allowing for genuine human freedom.

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## Chapter 10 | Part Four: Open Theism and Religious Life| Q&A

### 1.Question

**What is the primary aim of the co-creator model in understanding petitionary prayer?**

Answer:The co-creator model aims to explain the efficacy of petitionary prayer as a participatory act where both humans and God work together to bring about the conditions for possible outcomes, emphasizing the importance of faith, persistence, and the relationality between God and humans.

### 2.Question

**How does the co-creator model differ from the naturalistic model of prayer?**

Answer:Unlike the naturalistic model, which sees prayer working through paranormal influences without God's direct involvement, the co-creator model posits that God plays an active role in responding to prayers, thus enhancing their efficacy.

### 3.Question

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## **What role does faith play in the effectiveness of prayer according to the co-creator model?**

Answer: Faith in the co-creator model is seen as a dynamic and active trust in God, which involves envisioning unreached possibilities and engaging in loving relationships with others, thus making prayers more effective.

### **4.Question**

## **Why does the author assert that unanswered prayers do not necessarily reflect a lack of faith?**

Answer: Unanswered prayers might result from various 'obstacles' in the spiritual realm, and not necessarily from a lack of faith or persistence. This view allows for the complexity of the prayer experience and acknowledges that some barriers may be beyond human understanding.

### **5.Question**

## **What does it mean to say that humans invite God into their lives through prayer?**

Answer: Inviting God into our lives through prayer implies a relational dynamic where humans express their desires for

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God to intervene, thus fostering a cooperative relationship in which both parties contribute to the unfolding of events in the world.

### 6.Question

**How does the co-creator model address the relationship between prayer and divine action?**

Answer:The co-creator model argues that prayer creates 'openings' for God to act, suggesting that God's actions in the world are often contingent on human cooperation through prayer.

### 7.Question

**In what way does the co-creator model emphasize the need for persistence in prayer?**

Answer:Persistence is seen as a demonstration of commitment and faith, which not only shows reliance on God but also engages one deeply in the process of co-creating outcomes, suggesting that consistent prayer helps maintain a relationship with God.

### 8.Question

**What significance does the author give to the spiritual**

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### **dimension in the context of prayer?**

Answer: The spiritual dimension is crucial as it encompasses the obstacles and forces that may influence the outcome of prayers, suggesting that both spiritual and earthly conditions need to be aligned for effective prayer.

### **9.Question**

#### **What is the connection-building theodicy mentioned in the text?**

Answer: The connection-building theodicy posits that the interdependence created through prayer and mutual support fosters lasting relationships and appreciation between individuals and God, enhancing the spiritual significance of human interactions.

### **10.Question**

#### **How does the author propose that prayer involves both asking and receiving?**

Answer: The author suggests that prayer is a complex act that involves expressing a desire for God's involvement and simultaneously surrendering the results to God, thus

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embodying both seeking and yielding.

## **Chapter 11 | Prayer and Open Theism| Q&A**

### **1.Question**

**What is the essence of the co-creator model in the context of petitionary prayer?**

Answer:The co-creator model posits that when individuals pray, they are entering into a participatory relationship with God, where both God and humans work together to bring about the desired outcomes. It emphasizes that prayer has real effects on the world, creating 'openings' for divine action and highlighting the dynamic interaction between human faith and God's will.

### **2.Question**

**How does the concept of faith influence the effectiveness of prayer according to the co-creator model?**

Answer:Faith is crucial in the co-creator model as it involves envisioning potential outcomes that align with God's purposes. This kind of faith is not merely belief but an active

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engagement with God, allowing individuals to participate in divine intentions and ensuring that prayers are offered from a state of trust and commitment.

### 3.Question

**What are some reasons provided for why some prayers may seem unanswered?**

Answer:Several explanations for unanswered prayers include the possibility of spiritual obstacles that inhibit divine action, the necessity for persistence and faith during prayer, and the idea that sometimes God's overarching will does not align with the specific requests made in prayer.

### 4.Question

**In what ways does the co-creator model address the relationship between prayer and divine agency?**

Answer:The co-creator model suggests that prayer directly affects the world and is itself a means through which God acts, rather than simply a request that God acts in a certain way. It recognizes that God has chosen to limit divine action to allow for meaningful human cooperation and involvement.

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## 5.Question

**What role does the Holy Spirit play in the co-creator model of prayer?**

Answer:The Holy Spirit is seen as an active agent who not only initiates prayers within individuals but also amplifies their efficacy, enhancing human intentions in accordance with God's will and facilitating a deep relational connection between God and the person praying.

## 6.Question

**Why is persistence emphasized in the New Testament as a requirement for effective prayer?**

Answer:Persistence is emphasized as a demonstration of faith and commitment to the request being made. Biblical passages highlight that ongoing, heartfelt prayer reinforces the believer's relationship with God and signifies a deep reliance on divine intervention.

## 7.Question

**How does the idea of envisioning future possibilities relate to faith in the co-creator model?**

Answer:Envisioning future possibilities is an integral aspect

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of faith in the co-creator model, as it reflects the proactive nature of faith. This creative capacity enables individuals to articulate their desires in prayer while actively participating in the unfolding of God's kingdom on Earth.

### 8.Question

**What insights can be drawn from the biblical passages referenced regarding the nature of prayer?**

Answer: Biblical passages concerning prayer consistently reflect the notion that prayer is a relational act intended to invite God into personal and communal circumstances, emphasizing the necessity of faith and perseverance as key components of that relationship.

### 9.Question

**How does the co-creator model suggest we should view God's responses to prayer?**

Answer: The model suggests viewing God's responses as collaborative and relational; rather than seeing prayer outcomes as merely dependent on God's sovereignty, it posits that God genuinely engages with human intentions and

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circumstances to co-create desired realities.

### 10.Question

**What implications does the co-creator model have on traditional views of God's omniscience and sovereignty?**

Answer: The co-creator model challenges strict interpretations of omniscience that imply determinism, allowing for a more dynamic understanding of God's knowledge and governance, suggesting that God knows all possible outcomes while remaining open to human choices and actions.

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# Metaphysics Quiz and Test

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## Chapter 1 | Part One: Open Theism and the Greatness of God| Quiz and Test

1. William Hasker argues that contemporary beliefs about God do not require a bigger understanding of the divine to align with modern science.
2. Open theism promotes the idea that God predetermines all actions of His creatures, ensuring complete control over their decisions.
3. Hasker supports the view that consciousness is an immaterial essence separate from the body, developed independently of physical processes.

## Chapter 2 | The Need for a Bigger God| Quiz and Test

1. William Hasker argues for a limited perception of God, which he believes aligns with outdated caricatures.
2. Open theism suggests that God allows individuals true

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freedom and autonomy rather than controlling every detail of existence.

- 3.The concept of 'bigness' in God equates to physical size rather than personal qualities such as strength and wisdom.

## **Chapter 3 | Part Two: Science and Open Theism| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Philosophers of science have had significant influence in academia, as suggested by the work of Thomas Kuhn and others.
- 2.The three layers of science include the empirical layer, the theoretical layer, and the methodological layer.
- 3.Open theism posits that the future is completely predetermined and does not involve human free will.

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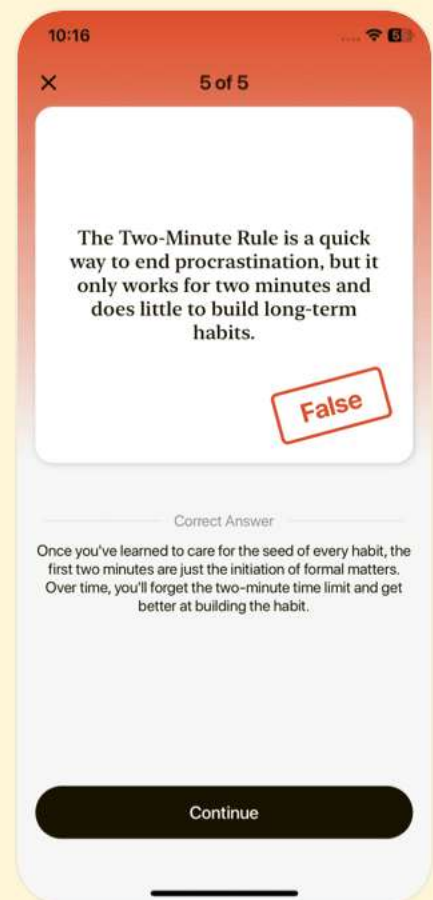
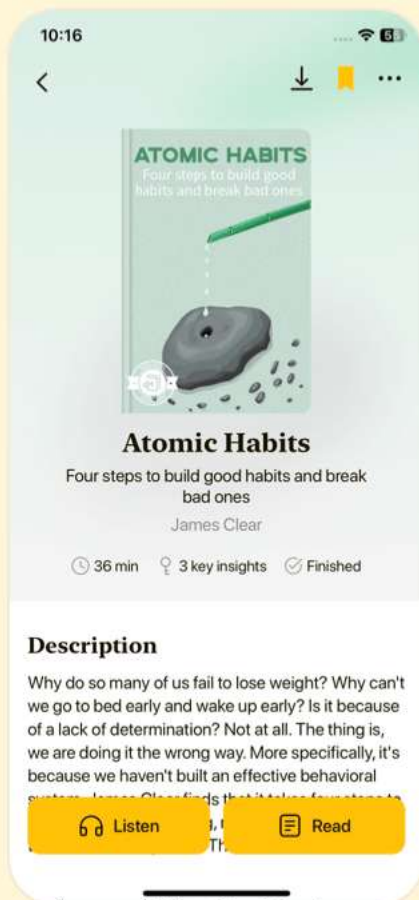


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## **Chapter 4 | Metatheoretic Shaping Principles| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Philosophers of science have historically been highly influential in academia.
- 2.Metatheoretic Shaping Principles (MSPs) refer to the principles that define what constitutes a good theory or law in science.
- 3.Open theism fully embraces determinism and denies the possibility of an open future.

## **Chapter 5 | Religious Belief Formation| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Individuals possess libertarian freedom to choose their religious beliefs amidst influencing factors.
- 2.Genetic factors do not have any influence on the formation of religious beliefs.
- 3.Awareness of influences on belief formation can objectively validate a specific perspective over others.

## **Chapter 6 | Part Three: Open Theism, Time, and Relativity| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Open theism supports the idea that the future is

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fully predetermined.

2.Causal openness implies that multiple futures are possible relative to the present moment.

3.God's knowledge is completely static and does not change with the unfolding of events in the future.

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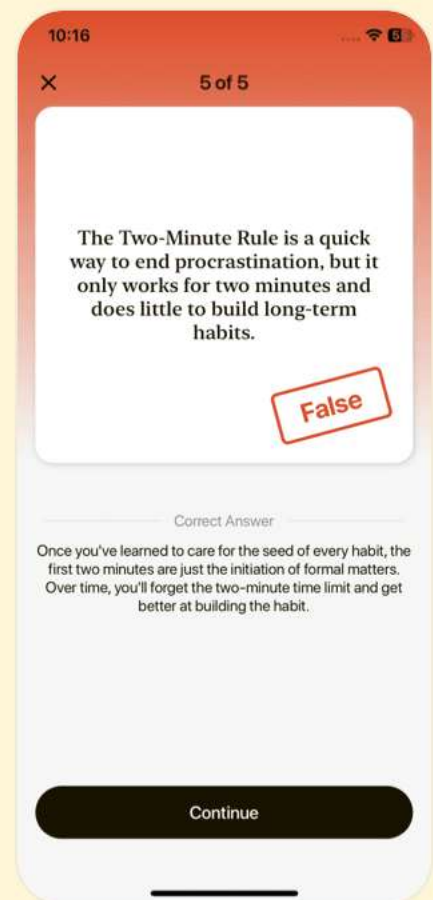
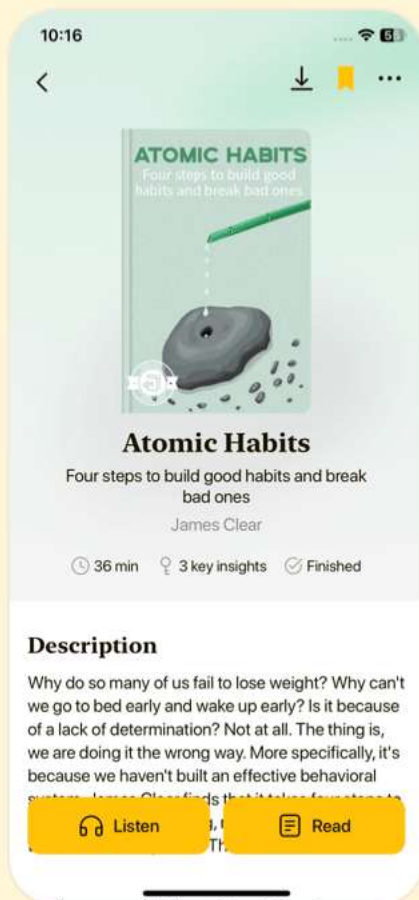


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## **Chapter 7 | The Fivefold Openness of the Future| Quiz and Test**

- 1.The future is entirely predetermined in open theism.
- 2.Open theism claims that the knowledge of the future is infallibly certain, even for God.
- 3.Causal openness implies that the future must also be open in other senses such as ontic, alethic, and epistemic.

## **Chapter 8 | Presentism and the Problem of Special Relativity| Quiz and Test**

- 1.Presentism posits that only currently existing entities are real, contrasting with eternalism which asserts that past and future entities are equally real.
- 2.Presentism faces no significant issues from scientific theories, including the theory of Special Relativity (SR).
- 3.Relationalism, as discussed in the chapter, suggests that time is defined through relations among existing entities and aligns with the principles of Open Theism.

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## Chapter 9 | Open Theism and the Metaphysics of the Space-Time Manifold| Quiz and Test

1. A-theorists advocate for an objective distinction between past, present, and future.
2. Presentism posits that only the future exists.
3. Open Theism and the A-theory of time accept that some propositions change their truth-value depending on temporal context.

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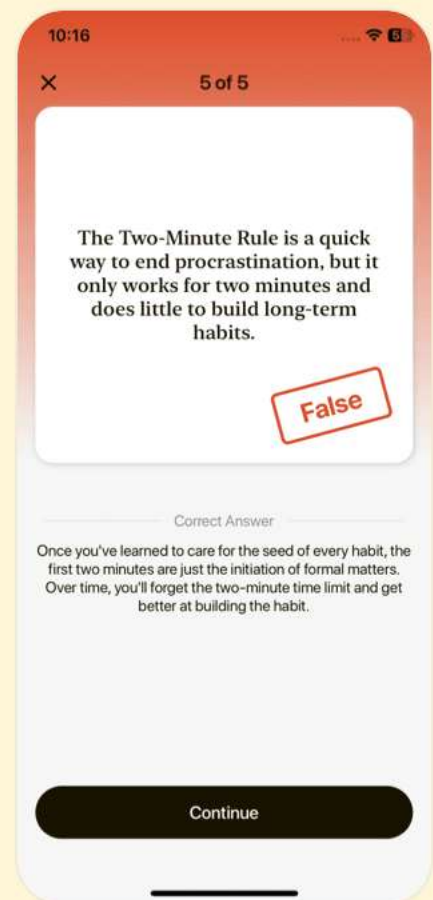
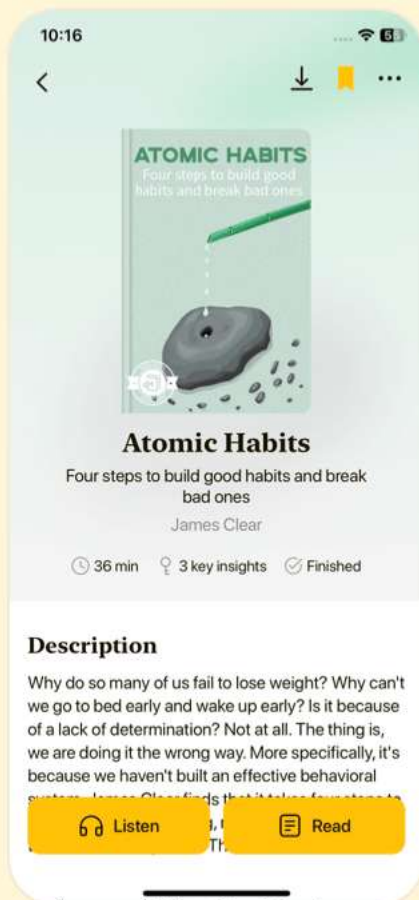


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## Chapter 10 | Part Four: Open Theism and Religious Life| Quiz and Test

1. According to the chapter, prayer solely acts as a psychological tool for self-transformation and has no impact on reality.
2. The open-theist perspective argues that prayer can effect real change by proposing a co-creator model where both humans and God collaborate in fulfilling prayer requests.
3. The co-creator model of prayer promotes the idea that God's predetermined decisions completely nullify the influence of human prayer.

## Chapter 11 | Prayer and Open Theism| Quiz and Test

1. The co-creator model asserts that prayer is merely a means to psychologically influence the participants involved.
2. In the co-creator model, God is portrayed as having a collaborative relationship with humans in the process of effectuating outcomes through prayer.
3. According to the paper, unanswered prayers always

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indicate divine neglect or disinterest on God's part.

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